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star trek didn't have a shuttle prop

12 July 2026

You are completely right. In the earliest episodes of *Star Trek: The Original Series*, the *USS Enterprise* did not have a shuttle prop. 🗨️ Reddit +1



Here is why they did not have one and how it changed:

- **The Budget Reason:** Television shows in the 1960s had very strict budgets. Building a full-size shuttle mockup and filming special effects of it launching or landing was too expensive. 🗨️ Quora +3
- **The Transporter:** To save money, the writers invented the **transporter**. "Beaming" characters to a planet was much cheaper to create than filming a physical shuttle. 📘 Facebook · Star Trek the... +2
- **The First Shuttle:** Shuttles were mentioned in the show's rulebook, but they did not appear on screen until much later in the first season, in an episode called "*The Galileo Seven*". 📘 Facebook · Star Trek the ... +1
- **The Toy Deal:** The studio finally built a physical shuttle prop after a toy company agreed to pay for it in exchange for the rights to sell model toys. 📘 Facebook · Star Trek the Or...

If you want to know more, I can tell you:

- What **episodes** the shuttle was used in first
 - How shuttle **props** were updated in the later *Star Trek: The Next Generation* movies and shows
- Let me know which you would like to explore!

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what was the episode where the crew waited for a transporter when a shuttle would have done, before the... ▾

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That episode is "**The Enemy Within**" (Season 1, Episode 5). 🚫 Science Fiction & Fantasy ...

In this famous episode, a **transporter malfunction splits Captain Kirk into two distinct versions** of himself—one gentle and indecisive, and the other aggressive and volatile. 📖 Fandom

Because the transporter is damaged and unsafe to use, **Sulu and a landing party are left stranded on the surface of planet Alfa 177**. The episode's primary tension comes from the crew racing against time to fix the transporter while the planet's temperature plummets to a freezing **120 degrees below zero**, leaving Sulu's team in imminent danger of freezing to





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- How the writers later **explained away** the missing shuttles in *Star Trek* books
- The **bizarre prop** they used as an alien dog to test the broken transporter 🤖 Reddit · r/startrek +1

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